

Natural Science Society

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Logo:

1 About us:

The Natural Science Society (NSS) is a non-profit and non-governmental organization that was established in 2020 and is registered with the Government of Nepal. The fact that it is registered with both the District Administration Office in Kathmandu (registration number: 5059) and the Social Welfare Council in Kathmandu (registration number: 52053) demonstrates its commitment to transparency and compliance with local regulations.

The organization's research team covers a diverse range of fields, including zoology, forestry, economics, and more. This multidisciplinary approach suggests that the NSS aims to address various aspects of natural science and conservation. The capacity to conduct both field and laboratory work further highlights the organization's commitment to scientific research and investigation. It is noteworthy that the team members hold at least a master's degree from the university, and some are even enrolled in PhD positions. This indicates a strong educational background and expertise within the team. Their knowledge and working experience in the field of conservation biology are particularly valuable, as this field plays a crucial role in preserving and protecting the natural environment.

Overall, the NSS seems well equipped and qualified to fulfill its objectives. By combining their multidisciplinary research approach, scientific expertise, and dedication to conservation biology, the organization has the potential to make significant contributions to the field of natural science and to the objectives of the NSS.

The major aims and objectives of the Natural Science Society (NSS) in Nepal include:

Protection of endangered species and habitats: NSS focuses on protecting endangered species and habitats in Nepal through conservation programs and campaigns.

Promotion of sustainable use of natural resources: NSS promotes sustainable use of natural resources in Nepal through education, research, and community engagement.

Raising awareness about environmental issues: NSS raises awareness about environmental issues in Nepal through education, research, and community engagement.

Promoting scientific research and education: NSS promotes scientific research and education in the field of natural sciences in Nepal, with a focus on conservation biology, ecology, and environmental science.

Environmental education and awareness: NSS focuses on environmental education and awareness programs for students, educators, and local communities.

2 Projects

Current

1. Ecology and conservation of striped hyena (*hyaena hyaena*) in lowland, Nepal

This research project aims to:

- Explore the suitable habitat, diet analysis and estimate the population of hyena
- Develop community conservation awareness programs highlighting the species ecological role.
- Promote the hyena conservation work at local level.

2. Nesting ecology and conservation of the lesser adjutant in Eastern Nepal

This research project aims to:

- To understand the effect of the pesticides on the lesser adjutant

Past

1. Tiger (*Panthera tigris*) conservation project in lowland of Nepal.

The endangered Bengal tiger is one of the top predators of the forest and grassland ecosystems. This project aims to conduct conservation awareness programs for long term conservation of tiger in Nepal. We are conducting school awareness programs, village group discussions to mitigate human-tiger conflict in Parsa-Chitwan Complex, Nepal.

Our specific objectives are:

- To understand the food behavior of tigers.
- To know the habitat suitability and movement ecology of tigers.
- To minimize the human-tiger conflict in Nepal's lowland.

2. Community stewardship for the sustainable conservation of Himalayan musk deer (*Moschus chrysogaster*) in Khaptad National Park, Nepal

Himalayan musk deer is one of the highlighted species in the Himalayan region and an 'Endangered' by IUCN Red List Category. It is also protected species by Nepal's National Park and Wildlife Conservation Act, 1973. Musk deer are facing threats highly; killing of musk deer by poachers for musk pod extraction is one of the greatest threats for this species so the population is in decreasing trend (Jnwali et al. 2011). Musk deer distributes at altitudinal range of 2,000-5,000 m asl (Harris 2016). Due to poaching, deforestation, habitat fragmentation and degradation, population of musk deer has been declining dramatically. Moreover, livestock depredation, overgrazing, forest fire, human encroachment for firewood and medicinal herbs collection are additional threats to the musk deer in this area. Therefore, it is very urgent to mitigate these threats for the existence of musk deer from Khaptad National Park (KNP) area of Nepal.

KNP lies in western part of Nepal and is a home for highly threatened species - snow leopard, red panda, musk deer, and several birds and plant species. There are wilderness areas along the rivers within the park that are crucial for transboundary movement of wild fauna. Anthropogenic pressure, poaching and lack of wildlife conservation program are additional problem in KNP. Besides of, poaching, people also hunt musk deer for meat, skin and tusk which is also one of the major problems in proposed study area.

In this project, our overall goal is to conservation musk deer in KNP. This project will contribute for long term conservation of the musk deer in KNP and its surroundings. Our project targets local community, park rangers and game-scouts, traders, buffer zone committee and school students to take conservation activities in KNP. This may helpful to sharing the ecological importance of the musk deer in the Himalayan region. Moreover, it also controls illegal collection of firewood, medicinal herbs, and overgrazing in KNP.

3. Publications

Scientific articles:

Baral, K., Adhikari, B., Bhandari, S., Kunwar, R. M., Sharma, H. P., Aryal, A., & Ji, W. (2023). Impact of climate change on distribution of common leopard (*Panthera pardus*) and its implication on conservation and conflict in Nepal. *Heliyon*, e12807.

Baral, K., Bhandari, S., Adhikari, B., Kunwar, R. M., Sharma, H. P., Aryal, A., & Ji, W. (2022). Anthropogenic mortality of large mammals and trends of conflict over two decades in Nepal. *Ecology and Evolution*, 12(10), e9381.

Adhikari, B., Bhandari, S., Baral, K., Lamichhane, S., & Subedi, S. C. (2022). Raptors at risk: Attributes of mortality within an anthropogenic landscape in the Mid-Hills region of Nepal. *Global Ecology and Conservation*, 38, e02258.

Adhikari, B., Baral, K., Bhandari, S., Kunwar, R. M., & Subedi, S. C. (2022). Prevalence of mortality in mammals: A retrospective study from wildlife rescue center of Nepal. *Conservation Science and Practice*, e12799.

Bhandari, S., Adhikari, B., Baral, K., Panthi, S., Kunwar, R. M., Thapamagar, T., ... & Youlatos, D. (2022). Climate change threatens striped hyena (*Hyaena hyaena*) distribution in Nepal. *Mammal Research*, 67: 433–443.

Bhandari, S., Adhikari, B., Baral, K., & Subedi, S. C. (2022). Greater one-horned rhino (*Rhinoceros unicornis*) mortality patterns in Nepal. *Global Ecology and Conservation*, e02189.

Bhandari S, Ramiro DC, Stabach JA (2022) Spatial segregation between wild ungulates and livestock outside protected areas in the lowlands of Nepal. *PloSOne*, 17(1): e0263122.

Adhikari, B., Baral, K., Bhandari, S., Szydlowski, M., Kunwar, R. M., Panthi, S., Neupane, B., & Koirala, R. K. (2022). Potential risk zone for anthropogenic mortality of carnivores in Gandaki Province, Nepal. *Ecology and Evolution*, 12, e8491.

Bhandari S, Bhusal DR, Psaralexi M, Sgardelis S (2021) Habitat preference indicators for striped hyena (*Hyaena hyaena*) in Nepal. *Global Ecology and Conservation*. 27, e01619.

Bhandari S, Youlatos D, Thapamagar T, Bhusal DR (2021). Shrinking striped hyena (*Hyaena hyaena* Linnaeus, 1758) distribution in Nepal. *European Journal of Wildlife Research*. 67, 10.

Newsletters/Reports:

An annual report is available in the office. If you need a PDF, please email us. Thank you.

Posters/Brochures:

We have some amazing posters and brochures of the musk deer, hyenas, pangolins, and tigers; please visit the office to get hard copies of those. If you need a PDF, please email us. Thank you.

4. Our People

Advisors

Dionisios Youlatos, PhD
Aristotle University of Thessaloniki, Greece

Mr. David Johnson
Denver Zoo and Katie Adamson Conservation Fund, USA

Executive Members:

Mr. Shivish Bhandari (President)
Mr. Anil KC (Vice President)
Mr. Tilak Thapamagar (Secretary)
Ms. Indra Ghimire (Treasure)
Mr. Sital Budhathoki (Member)
Ms. Kasturi Gurung (Member)
Ms. Jenish Thakuri (Member)
Ms. Punam Sunar (Member)
Ms. Anjeela Pandey (Member)

Staffs:

Binaya Adhikar (Coordinator)

Rakshya Basnet (Research Assistant)

Volunteers

Sam Murray, US

Bryce Mawhinney, USA

5. Opportunity

Thesis/Research Grant:

We support thesis grant to the Masters Degree student. However, at this moment there is no announcement for the research grant.

Past research grantee (2022): Ms Keshari Thapamagar (Grant for musk deer conservation in Makalu Barun National park, grant amount: N.Rs. 45,000.00).

Volunteer/Internship:

We are accepting applications from national and international university students and young researchers. If you are interested in volunteering or interning at the Natural Science Society, please send us an email. We would appreciate it if you had any projects in mind. For more details about volunteering, please contact Shivish Bhandari (shivish.bhandari@yahoo.com).

6. Support us

Membership

If you are interested in becoming a member of the NSS, please contact us. We have three types of membership:

General membership cost: N.Rs. 1000.00 one time, and yearly N.Rs. 500 Only.

Lifetime membership cost: N.Rs. 5,000.00 one time.

Student membership cost: N.Rs. 200.00 one time, and yearly N.Rs. 100 Only.

Donation

Name: Natural Science Society

Name of the Bank: Rastriya Banijya Bank

Branch: Kirtipur Branch, Kathmandu, Nepal

Bank account no: 1170100050419001

Swift code: RBBANPKA

News/Events

We will announce the bird watching program in Kathmandu valley. Please keep in touch with us. Thank you so much!

Our Partners

Katie Adamson Conservation Fund (KACF)

Idea Wild

Important links

Tribhuvan University (<https://tribhuvan-university.edu.np/>)

National Academy of Science and Technology (<https://nast.gov.np/>)

Facebook Page: <https://www.facebook.com/naturalsciencesocietynepal>

YouTube:

Twitter: